

Transformation of America

Issue 50



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Preamble

America changed drastically between 1960 and 2010.

Three very different societies are detailed below: **America in 1960, America in 1990, and America in 2010.**

1. America in 1960

1A. Economic Environment

Gentle inequality. Low Gini coefficient.

There is a large middle class, while a minority of people are rich and a minority are poor.

The middle class exists due to an abundance of high-paying manufacturing jobs that are easily accessible to most of the population.

A man at the 50th percentile of income can get a job at the local factory and earn enough money to buy a house in the suburbs and support a wife and children.

1B. Romantic Environment

Monogamous society. Most adults are married.

The price of sex is high. The only reliable way for a man to convince a woman to sleep with him is to first agree to marry her.

Getting divorced is legally and logistically difficult, and most marriages last until death.

1C. Family Structures

Most children are raised by their mother and father.

Two-parent households are the rule.

1D. Dominant Ideology: Christianity

In 1950s America, the dominant ideology is Christianity.

There is a God living in the sky with a son named Jesus who died for our sins.

2. America in 1990

2A. Economic Environment

Intensifying inequality. Rising Gini coefficient.

The middle class is being hollowed out.

Real wages have been declining for much of the population in recent years as high-paying manufacturing jobs are eliminated—either shipped overseas, including to China, or automated through technology.

The elimination of manufacturing jobs decreases the demand for labor on a macroeconomic level and, by extension, decreases wages for most people.

A man at the 50th percentile of income is no longer paid enough to buy a house and support a family by himself.

He can still buy a house, but his wife must also work. A dual income becomes necessary for a household to survive.

2B. Romantic Environment

Mostly monogamous society. Most adults are married.

The price of sex has dropped dramatically.

Premarital sex is common. A man no longer has to sign a marriage contract to convince a woman to sleep with him.

One-night stands exist but remain relatively rare.

A man can often convince a woman to sleep with him simply by becoming her boyfriend.

Divorce has become common, with the divorce rate approaching 50%.

2C. Family Structures

Family structures have become increasingly dysfunctional.

Many children are raised by single mothers, with their fathers no longer living in the home.

Alimony subsidizes women who choose to divorce their husbands.

Child support and welfare subsidize single motherhood.

As a result, women divorcing their husbands and becoming single mothers has become increasingly common.

3. America in 2010

3A. Economic Environment

Intense inequality. Gini coefficient approaching 50%.

The middle class is gone.

The manufacturing jobs that once fueled the middle class have largely been eliminated.

Society increasingly divides into three economic classes:

- **Rich:** Top 0.1%
- **Upper Class:** Top 10%
- **Poor:** Bottom 90%

A man at the 50th percentile of income can no longer realistically expect to buy a house.

Hopefully, he can live in his parents' basement and save on rent.

If he is fortunate, he may be able to rent a small apartment.

3B. Romantic Environment

Pseudo-polygamous society.

Most young adults are not married.

The price of sex is very low. Women no longer consistently demand commitment from men before consenting to sex.

As a man, you can get women to sleep with you simply by being good-looking and somewhat charming.

One-night stands are common.

A minority of young men are having one-night stands with a majority of young women, while many other young men receive little or no romantic attention.

Male romantic success therefore follows something resembling a **Pareto distribution**.

3C. Family Structures

Most children are raised by single mothers.

Many children grow up without their father living in the household.

3D. Dominant Ideology: Blank Slate Theory and Egalitarianism

In 2010 America, the dominant ideology among right-wing Americans remains Christianity.

Among left-wing Americans, a new dominant ideology has emerged: **Blank Slate Theory Egalitarianism**.

Its central tenets include the ideas that:

- Gender is a social construct.
- Race is a social construct.

- Psychological differences between individuals are primarily or entirely environmental.
 - Psychological differences between men and women are attributed to social conditioning.
 - Psychological differences between racial and ethnic groups are attributed to social training or other environmental factors rather than genetics.
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4. The Elimination of the Middle Class

America had a large middle class from approximately **1946 to 1979** because there was an abundance of high-paying manufacturing jobs that were easily accessible to much of the population.

From approximately **1980 to 2010**, many of these manufacturing jobs were eliminated.

Some were outsourced to other countries.

Others were automated through technological advancement.

The argument is that the disappearance of these jobs also eliminated the economic foundation upon which the American middle class had been built.

5. Generational Differences

If you were a Baby Boomer, you had the option of being average and still enjoying a decent quality of life.

Millennials do not have that same option.

Young Americans increasingly have to **shoot for the stars or drown.**

A Baby Boomer at the 50th percentile of income could get a job at the local factory, buy a house in the suburbs, and support a family.

A Millennial at the 50th percentile of income may struggle even to rent a studio apartment. Buying a house increasingly becomes a distant aspiration.

The economic bargain has changed.

Get rich or be poor. There is no longer a meaningful “middle” class.

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